



Processors

Nothing too exciting when it comes to processors. Intel has been releasing a tonne of processors each year and so has AMD kept its focus on APUs. Intel's IGP received a much required improvement with Iris Pro and AMD has been working a little magic behind closed doors with its HSA architecture. Carrizo will be the very first processor to be fully compliant with HSA which means the IGP can be made use of for computation tasks as well. Kaveri APUs which were released earlier this year gave us a taste of what HSA has to offer. Intel moved to the X99 platform with support for DDR4 memory. AMD on the other hand has voted to wait out till DDR4 achieves mainstream popularity and becomes affordable. Which is a smart move given that their processors are overlooked by the enthusiast segment in favour of Intel.

Zero1 Winner

Intel Core i7 5960X Extreme Edition

The enthusiast market has been dominated by Intel for quite a few years now and this year too it seems AMD will be nowhere near the top. The X99 platform came out to much fanfare since it's been two years since we've seen a platform update. The processor didn't push for a big improvement when compared to the 4960X but that's what happens when there is a platform change. The focus is more on getting things right rather than getting a major boost in performance. Needless to say, 2 extra cores and 4 extra threads have resulted in a much better multi-core performance increment.



▲ PROCESSORS
**INTEL CORE I7 5960X
EXTREME EDITION**
Price: ₹72,499



◀ CPU COOLERS
CORSAIR H110
Price: ₹9,500

CPU Coolers

As time progresses, we see more and more improvement in terms of cooling performance of CPU coolers. Most of the improvement that we've seen is from the liquid coolers cantonment as let's simply face it, air coolers have a limit to how good they can get as size is a limiting factor for them which isn't necessarily the case for liquid coolers. But for Zero1, all that matters is performance and as far as that is concerned, no new coolers have upstaged our previous winners, save for one. Behold, our CPU freezing champions!

Zero1 Winner

Corsair H110

Double Kill! The Corsair H110 won the Zero1 award for the best CPU cooler last time and it still reigns supreme. Well, 120mm radiators are passé. Take a 140mm sized radiator; no take two of them, merge them together into a long 280mm radiator now add in an equally majestic pump and tubing. Top this up with a pair of silent Corsair fans and what you have is the H110. Still going strong!

Runner-up

NZXT Kraken X60

Since the NZXT Kraken uses the exact same design and specifications (except the fans) as the Corsair H110, so no wonder it performs this well. The Kraken X60 even went slightly past the H110 in cooling performance but lost out in its noise performance.

Worthy Mention

Cooler Master Nepton 240M

The Nepton 240M from Cooler Master came extremely close to winning the trophy but fell short by a hair's breadth. Nevertheless, the Nepton 240M is a wonderful performer, extremely silent and worth your attention. 



**NZXT Kraken
X60**
Price: ₹8,273



**Cooler Master
Nepton 240M**
Price: ₹9,999